

Middle Blocking Focus

Before the play...

1. Watch
 - a. Gather intel between plays
 - b. Steal setter signals
2. Talk!
 - a. Call out attackers
 - b. Where attackers are coming from (stack right, split, etc)
 - c. Think about:
 - i. Scouting report and tendencies – who's the go-to?
 - ii. What they did last in this rotation
 - d. Let your wing blockers know what you're doing
 - i. Committing in 2 hitter front, Fronting, etc
3. Ready Position
 - a. A little more than elbow distance from the net and comfortable
 - i. You will ALWAYS stay on this track as you move laterally along net
 - b. Hands in front of face – looking at the back of your hands
 - c. Feet shoulder width apart – balanced on your toes
 - d. Knees/legs bent and loaded – ready to explode vertically or horizontally
 - e. Head stays neutral throughout play – Watch with your peripheral vision
 - i. Do NOT follow the ball with your head

Eye Sequence: Ball-Hitter-Setter-Ball-Hitter

1. Ball: watch flight of ball as it is passed. Follow with your eyes; NOT your head
 - a. Identify the pass (3 or 1/2) – Is middle on or off?
 - b. If pass is on: Stay in loaded posture ready to block quick ball
 - c. If pass is off: Drop your hands. In 2 hitter front, or situation where a pin hitter is eliminated, also take shuffle step towards outside
2. Hitter: Find the hitter you are responsible for to understand their route or anyone else coming to your zone
 - a. When taking tracking steps, these should be fast shuffles and you should maintain your balanced weight, spacing to net, hands in front of face, and feet shoulder width apart
3. Setter: Focus on reading setter's hands as she released the ball
 - a. Your feet must be stopped and balanced before ball is entering setter's hands
 - b. See if you can gather any tells from setter
4. Ball: Watch flight of ball and move quickly to get in front of ball and attackers angle of approach
5. Hitter: Switch focus to your hitter's approach angle and arm as you get ready to jump and block
 - a. Timing is key
 - b. Pay attention to hitters arm because it is less deceiving

Block Move

1. Balance:
 - a. Jump with feet/hips squared to the net and land with them squared to net
 - b. Land as close to your takeoff point as possible
2. Vision
 - a. See the backs of your hands when you penetrate net
 - b. KEEP YOUR HEAD UP – you must be able to see hitter when contacting the ball
 - i. This will make transition much easier and help you find ball off touch or tip
3. Arms and Hands
 - a. Press low across net
 - b. Wrists in neutral position with hands finishing OVER ball
 - i. Do NOT extend wrists with palms facing back wall
 - c. Place closing hand into the seam. Inside hand should go straight across net, or dropped into hard angle if you are early enough to set up

CONTROL THE NET – IT IS YOURS!